

WORKING WEEK

Ten lunches. One Sunday.

Cook once on Sunday and stop deciding what to eat at 12:45 with twenty minutes and no plan. Balanced, packable meals that survive a fridge, a bag and a hot commute.

10 packed lunches

6 recipes

One 2-hour prep

Desk-friendly

**±R60**
PER MEAL**2 hrs**
SUNDAY PREP**34–45g**
PROTEIN PER LUNCH

WHY THIS BEATS BUYING LUNCH

Two hours on Sunday buys back **your week.**

A bought lunch in South Africa runs R90 to R130. This plan lands around R60 a meal, hits 34–45 g of protein, and removes the single decision that sinks most people's nutrition: what to eat when you're already hungry and already busy.

1

Pick two mains, not five

Variety is where meal prep dies. Two mains across ten lunches is repeatable. Rotate the pair every week and you'll never eat the same fortnight twice.

2

Build every box the same way

A palm of protein, a fist of starch, two fists of vegetables, a thumb of fat. No weighing, no app-fighting, no maths at the counter.

3

Pack Sunday, grab Monday

Five boxes go in the fridge, five go in the freezer and come forward on Wednesday night. Breakfast is built the same evening, in jars.



Five in the **fridge.** Five in the **freezer.**

Thursday and Friday you are eating Sunday's food, and it still tastes like Sunday.

2

MAINS PER WEEK

10

LUNCHES PACKED

±R900

WEEKLY SHOP

R400+

SAVED VS BUYING

ONE TROLLEY • ONE PERSON • 10 LUNCHES + 5 BREAKFASTS

The working week list.

Everything here does double duty. Buy it once, cook it twice, eat it five days — and don't be precious about brands. House-brand chicken and store-brand rice do the same job for less.

PROTEIN & DAIRY

EST.

☐ Chicken breast fillets	1.5 kg	R190
☐ Lean beef mince	500 g	R95
☐ Hake fillets	400 g	R75
☐ Eggs	18	R58
☐ Plain / Greek yoghurt	1 kg	R60

CARBS & PRODUCE

EST.

☐ Brown rice	2 kg	R70
☐ Sweet potato	2 kg	R45
☐ Wholewheat penne	500 g	R30
☐ Oats	1 kg	R40
☐ Butternut cubes	700 g	R40

VEGETABLES

EST.

☐ Spinach	300 g	R30
☐ Green beans	500 g	R35
☐ Mixed peppers	3-pack	R40
☐ Bananas	1 kg	R28

CUPBOARD

EST.

☐ Tinned chopped tomato	×3	R36
☐ Chakalaka	×2	R30

Trolley total

±R900

15 meals · roughly **R60 each** · about half the price of a bought lunch.

SHOP IT ANYWHERE



Prices are typical South African shelf estimates and will vary by store, province and week. FitSocial is not affiliated with, endorsed by or sponsored by any retailer shown.

RUN IT IN THIS ORDER

Oven first. Stove second. Boxes last.

Anything that bakes goes in before anything that needs watching. By the time the trays come out, the pots are done and everything cools together.

0 → 20 MIN

Trays in the oven

Oven to 200°C. Sweet potato and butternut on one tray, peri-peri chicken on another, green beans on a third for the last 12 minutes.

20 → 45 MIN

Rice and sauce

Brown rice on to simmer. In a second pot, start the bolognese — onion, mince, tomato, then leave it low.

45 → 80 MIN

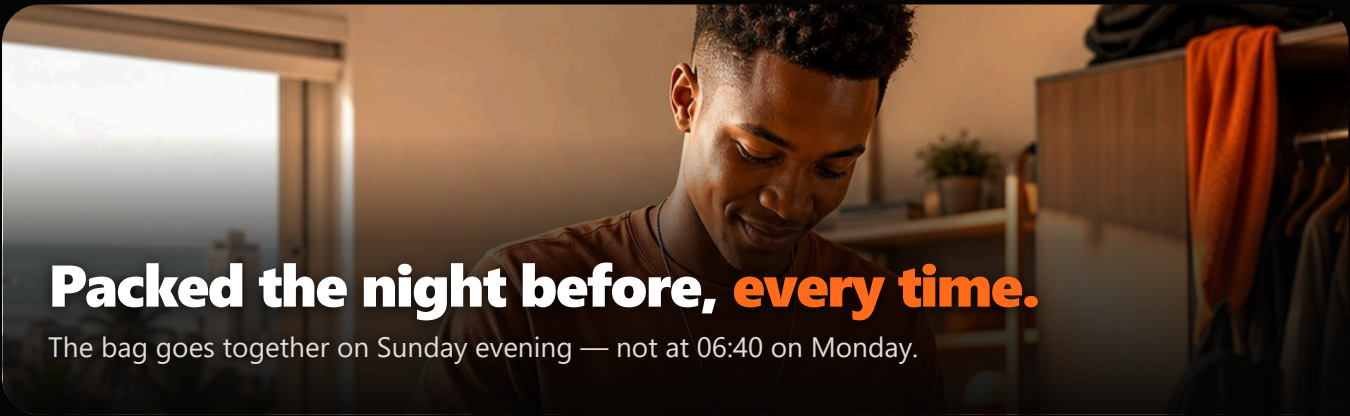
Second main

Chicken and butternut curry goes on while the oven finishes. This is the one that freezes best, so it's your Thursday and Friday.

80 → 120 MIN

Cool, box, jar

Everything cools uncovered for 20 minutes. Then: five boxes to the fridge, five to the freezer, and five breakfast jars built while you wait.



Packed the night before, every time.

The bag goes together on Sunday evening — not at 06:40 on Monday.

HOW THE TEN BOXES LAND

Mon Chicken, brown rice & roast veg**Tue** Peri-peri chicken & sweet potato**Wed** Beef & veg bolognese**Thu** Chicken & butternut curry (**freezer**)**Fri** Baked hake & chakalaka (**freezer**)**Breakfast** Oat jars & yoghurt bowls

The boxes that carry Monday to Wednesday.



MEAL PREP

01

Chicken, Brown Rice & Roast Veg Bowl

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	MAKES
520 kcal	45 g	4

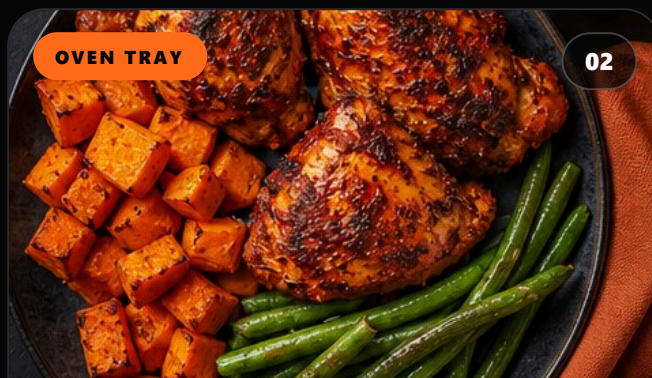
YOU NEED • 4 BOXES

- 800 g chicken breast fillets
- 2 cups brown rice, uncooked
- 2 peppers, 1 courgette, 1 red onion
- 2 tbsp olive oil, 1 tsp paprika
- Salt, pepper, lemon

METHOD

1. Oven to 200°C. Toss the chopped veg in oil, paprika, salt and roast 22 minutes.
2. Rub the chicken with oil and seasoning; roast 20–24 minutes until just cooked through.
3. Simmer the rice, then spread it on a tray to cool fast.
4. Rest the chicken 5 minutes, slice, and build: rice, veg, chicken, squeeze of lemon.

Prep tip: Slice the chicken only when you box it — whole breast holds moisture far better.



OVEN TRAY

02

Peri-Peri Chicken, Sweet Potato & Beans

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	MAKES
480 kcal	38 g	4

YOU NEED • 4 BOXES

- 8 chicken thighs, skin on
- 1 kg sweet potato, cubed
- 500 g green beans, trimmed
- 3 tbsp peri-peri sauce, 1 tbsp oil
- 1 lemon, garlic, paprika

METHOD

1. Oven to 200°C. Coat the thighs in peri-peri, garlic and lemon; leave 10 minutes.
2. Toss the sweet potato in oil and paprika; spread on a tray and roast 30 minutes.
3. Add the chicken to its own tray and roast 28–32 minutes, until the skin crisps.
4. Throw the beans in for the last 12 minutes so they keep their bite.

Prep tip: Two trays, one oven, one wash-up. This is the fastest R60 lunch in the pack.

Thursday and Friday, solved on Sunday.



FREEZER READY

03

Chicken & Butternut Curry

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	MAKES
430 kcal	34 g	5

YOU NEED • 5 SERVINGS

- 700 g chicken breast, cubed
- 700 g butternut cubes
- 1 onion, 2 cloves garlic, thumb of ginger
- 2 tbsp curry powder, 1 tin coconut milk
- Handful of spinach, rice to serve

METHOD

1. Fry the onion, garlic and ginger 4 minutes, then the curry powder for 30 seconds.
2. Add the chicken and seal it on all sides.
3. Pour in the coconut milk and butternut; simmer 20 minutes until the squash softens.
4. Stir the spinach through at the end and let it wilt off the heat.

Prep tip: Freeze the curry and the rice separately — reheated rice is much better that way.



LOCAL FUEL

04

Baked Hake, Samp & Chakalaka

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	MAKES
450 kcal	34 g	2

YOU NEED • 2 SERVINGS

- 400 g hake fillets
- 1 cup samp, soaked overnight (or couscous)
- 1 tin chakalaka
- 1 lemon, 1 tbsp olive oil
- Paprika, garlic, black pepper

METHOD

1. Simmer the soaked samp 45–55 minutes until tender, then drain.
2. Oven to 190°C. Lay the hake on baking paper, oil it, season, top with lemon.
3. Bake 14–16 minutes — it's done when it flakes with light pressure.
4. Warm the chakalaka and plate all three together.

Prep tip: Fish is the one main to eat within two days. Keep it for Friday's box, not the freezer.

One big pot. One **two-minute** breakfast.



Beef & Veg Bolognese

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	MAKES
540 kcal	34 g	5

YOU NEED • 5 SERVINGS

- 500 g lean beef mince
- 1 onion, 2 carrots, 1 courgette, grated
- 2 tins chopped tomato, 1 tbsp tomato paste
- 500 g wholewheat penne
- Mixed herbs, garlic, 1 stock cube

METHOD

1. Fry the onion, carrot and courgette until they collapse — 8 minutes, don't rush it.
2. Add the mince and brown it properly before any liquid goes in.
3. Stir in tomato, paste, stock and herbs; simmer 25 minutes uncovered.
4. Cook the pasta, rinse it cold, and box it under the sauce.

Prep tip: Grated vegetables disappear into the sauce. It's the easiest way to get five portions of veg into a fussy week.



Greek Yoghurt, Berries & Nuts

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	TIME
230 kcal	18 g	2 min

YOU NEED • 1 SERVING

- 200 g plain or Greek yoghurt
- ½ cup berries or chopped fruit
- 1 tbsp mixed seeds
- 1 tbsp chopped nuts
- Optional: drizzle of honey

METHOD

1. Spoon the yoghurt into a jar or tub with a proper lid.
2. Layer the fruit on top, then the seeds and nuts.
3. Seal and refrigerate — build up to three at a time.
4. Stir at your desk. That's it.

Prep tip: Keep nuts and seeds in a separate small bag if you're making these more than a day ahead. Crunch matters.

PACKING, REHEATING AND THE DAYS IT FALLS APART

The unglamorous part that **actually works.**

Meal prep rarely fails at the cooking. It fails at the packing, the reheating and the one late meeting that eats your lunch hour. Plan for those and the week holds.

PACK IT PROPERLY

Sauce	Under the starch, never on top of greens
Salad	Own container, dressing in a small tub
Rice & pasta	Cooled fast, boxed cold, sealed cold
Fish	Eat within two days, don't freeze once cooked
Fruit	Whole and loose — it survives a bag better

REHEAT WITHOUT RUINING IT

Rice bowls	Splash of water, cover, 2 min, stir, 1 min
Curry & stew	From frozen: fridge overnight, then 3 min
Roast veg	Undercook by 3 min on Sunday so day four isn't mush
Chicken breast	Reheat whole, slice after — it stays tender
Pasta	Reheat the sauce, add cold pasta last 30 seconds

WHEN THE WEEK GOES SIDEWAYS

01 Missed prep? Cook double at dinner, box the half

02 Late meeting? Eat the box at 15:00, not never

03 Bored by Thursday? Change the sauce, not the plan

04 Ate out? Log it and move on — one meal is not a week

4 days

FRIDGE RULE

2 months

FREEZER RULE

<2 hrsCOOL BEFORE
SEALING**70°C**REHEAT RIGHT
THROUGH

This guide is general nutrition information for healthy adults, not medical or dietetic advice. If you are pregnant, managing a health condition, or working with a dietitian, check with them before changing how you eat.

TEN BOXES DOWN. NOW DO IT AGAIN.

Track the week you **actually** had.

The second week is where meal prep either becomes a habit or becomes a story you tell about that one Sunday. Log your meals, your macros and your training in FitSocial, and let the streak do the arguing.



Scan to get early access

fitsocial.co.za

FitSocial launches on Android and iOS. Join the waitlist to get your invite before the public launch — founding members get free early access, locked-in founding pricing and a say in the roadmap.

- ✓ Log meals and macros in seconds
- ✓ Track workouts, runs and streaks
- ✓ Share progress with your circle
- ✓ Build South African grocery plans
- ✓ See weekly trends, not single days
- ✓ Free core logging, always